

Spatial History Map 2: Commodity and Empire

Due: Monday, October 12 at 11:59 PM

Value: 40 points

Format: Annotated historical map

Purpose

Trace how one commodity linked extraction, labor, transport, finance, consumption, and coercive power between 1850 and 1914.

Your task

- Choose rubber, cotton, tea, palm oil, copper, or opium and define a 30-60 year period.
- Map at least two production zones, two transport nodes, one financing or administrative center, and two consumption markets.
- Use arrows and line weight to distinguish movement of commodity, capital, labor, and military or administrative force.
- Add five source-based annotations, including labor conditions and one environmental consequence.
- Write a 250-word caption explaining where power accumulated and which mapped connection best supports that claim.

Submit

- Landscape PDF map and 250-word interpretive caption.
- Chicago-style source credits for data, claims, and base map.

Grading criteria

Criterion	Pts	Full-credit evidence
Historical evidence	10	Uses accurate dates, locations, movements, and source-based annotations.
Spatial reasoning	10	Map design reveals a process or relationship rather than only labeling places.
Interpretive caption	10	Makes a defensible claim and explains what the spatial pattern shows.
Visual communication	6	Legend, symbols, scale, hierarchy, and labels are clear and accessible.
Source credits	4	Provides complete citations and rights or provenance information.

Submission standards

Upload a readable PDF unless the handout specifies another format. Include your name, course code, and assignment title. Cite borrowed ideas and retain the editable source file. The learning portal timestamp is the official submission time.